AURAE · UX RESEARCH

# UX Research · Mental Wellness

What we know about the problem, who it affects in Thailand, and what Aurae must get right. Secondary data is cited; primary research is the plan to validate it.

### RESEARCH GOALS

1. Understand why young working adults in Thailand delay getting mental-health help
2. Find the moments when a low-effort self-care tool is actually used
3. Learn what builds enough trust to book and pay for a psychologist

### METHODS

| Status | Method | Details |
|---|---|---|
| Done | Desk research | WHO, Thai Health Report 2025, Ipsos 2025, app-retention studies |
| Done | Competitive review | Meditation apps, AI chat companions, teletherapy platforms |
| Planned | User interviews | 12 × 45 min · ages 18–35 · Bangkok + 2 regional cities |
| Planned | Online survey | n ≈ 150 · stress, sleep, help-seeking, willingness to pay |
| Planned | Usability test | 5–6 users per round · check-in, booking, SOS flows |

### SECONDARY RESEARCH · KEY NUMBERS

| Figure | Finding | Source |
|---|---|---|
| 1 in 7 | people worldwide lived with a mental disorder in 2021 | WHO, 2025 |
| 359M | people had an anxiety disorder in 2021 — the most common mental disorder | WHO, 2025 |
| ~1 in 3 | people with depression receive formal mental-health care | WHO |
| 13.4M | Thais have experienced mental-health problems or psychiatric disorders | Thai Health Report 2025 |
| 40% | of Thais name stress as the country's top health problem | Ipsos Health Service Report 2025 |
| 3.3% | median 30-day retention of popular mental-health apps | Baumel et al., JMIR 2019 |

### KEY INSIGHTS · TO VALIDATE

**Stress is the everyday problem**
Most people talk about stress and sleep, not "mental illness". Language matters for first use.

**Help arrives too late**
Care gaps and stigma mean people wait until things are serious before reaching out.

**Apps are dropped fast**
Retention collapses within weeks. Value has to show in the first 3 days, not month 2.

**Trust before payment**
Price, privacy and therapist fit are the barriers to booking a real session.

### COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

| | Meditation apps | AI companions | Teletherapy | Aurae |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Daily mood check-in | ✓ | ✓ | — | ✓ |
| Guided breathing & CBT | ✓ | ✓ | — | ✓ |
| Pattern insights | — | ✓ | — | ✓ |
| Book a psychologist | — | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Crisis help (1323) | — | — | ✓ | ✓ |
| Thai-first experience | — | — | ✓ | ✓ |

Category-level review, not a feature audit of specific products.

### PROBLEM & OPPORTUNITIES

**PROBLEM STATEMENT**
Young working adults in Thailand feel stressed most days but put off help until it's serious, because self-care feels like effort and therapy feels costly, uncertain and stigmatised.

- **HMW** make a daily check-in take under 60 seconds and still feel useful?
- **HMW** turn mood data into one clear action, not another chart?
- **HMW** make booking a psychologist feel safe, affordable and private?
- **HMW** keep crisis help one tap away without making the app feel clinical?

DESIGN PRINCIPLES: Low effort first · Private by default · Warm, not clinical · Help is one tap away · Show progress kindly

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# Personas · Who we design for

Three proto-personas built from the secondary research. Mia is the primary persona; Krit and Ploy stretch the design for scepticism and limited budget.

## M Mia, 27 — Primary

Marketing executive · Bangkok

> *"I don't need therapy... I just need to stop feeling this tight before every deadline."*

Works long hours, sleeps around 5–6 hours on weeknights and feels anxious before big presentations. Has never seen a psychologist and isn't sure her stress is "serious enough".

**GOALS**
- Calm down fast before meetings
- Sleep better on weeknights
- Know when it's time to talk to someone

**FRUSTRATIONS**
- Self-care apps feel like homework
- Worries about who sees her data
- Doesn't know how to choose a therapist

**BEHAVIOUR & TECH**
- iPhone · ~6 h screen time / day
- Uses apps in short bursts (1–3 min)
- Pays for 2 subscriptions already

| | |
|---|---|
| Stress level | 78% |
| Openness to therapy | 55% |
| Tech comfort | 85% |

KEY SCREENS IN AURAE: 06 Check-in · 09 Breathing · 14 Insights · 22 Psychologists

## K Krit, 34 — Secondary

Software engineer · Chiang Mai

> *"Show me the data. If sleep is the problem, tell me — don't give me a quote of the day."*

Remote worker showing signs of burnout: irritable, low motivation, working late. Sceptical of wellness apps and worried therapy is expensive and "not for people like me".

**GOALS**
- Understand what drives his bad weeks
- Fix problems with small, practical steps
- Get help privately, outside office hours

**FRUSTRATIONS**
- Generic tips and motivational fluff
- Stigma about therapy among friends
- Unclear pricing and long waits

**BEHAVIOUR & TECH**
- Android + laptop · tracks sleep with a watch
- Reads long-form content at night
- Books services online, never by phone

| | |
|---|---|
| Stress level | 70% |
| Openness to therapy | 30% |
| Tech comfort | 95% |

KEY SCREENS IN AURAE: 14 Insights · 17 AI Mind Summary · 11 Thought Record · 25 My Sessions

## P Ploy, 20 — Edge case

University student · Khon Kaen

> *"At 2 a.m. it all gets heavy, and I don't want to wake anyone up."*

First-year student living away from home. Exam pressure, loneliness and social-media comparison leave her low most evenings. Tight budget; can't pay for regular sessions.

**GOALS**
- Feel less alone late at night
- Write things down without judgement
- Know where to turn if it gets too much

**FRUSTRATIONS**
- Can't afford private therapy
- Afraid friends will find out
- Overwhelmed by long sign-ups

**BEHAVIOUR & TECH**
- Budget Android · heavy social-media use
- Most active 10 p.m.–2 a.m.
- Prefers Thai-language content

| | |
|---|---|
| Stress level | 82% |
| Openness to therapy | 60% |
| Tech comfort | 70% |

KEY SCREENS IN AURAE: 12 Journal · 18 Aura AI Chat · 29 Get Help Now · 30 Safety Plan

Proto-personas based on secondary research (WHO 2025, Thai Health Report 2025, Ipsos 2025). Names and details are illustrative — validate with the planned interviews and survey.

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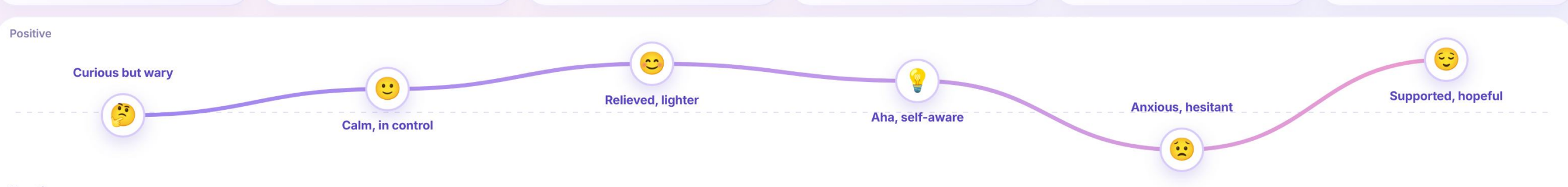
# Customer Journey Map

How Mia moves from first download to ongoing support — what she does, thinks and feels at each stage, and where Aurae can help more.

**M Mia, 27** Marketing executive · Bangkok
Works long hours, sleeps poorly and feels anxious before big deadlines. Wants a private, low-effort way to cope — and to know when it's time to talk to a professional.
Goal · Reduce stress · Goal · Sleep better · Fear · Being judged · Uses phone 6h / day

| | STAGE 1 · SCREENS 01–05<br>Discover & Onboard | STAGE 2 · SCREENS 06–08<br>Daily Check-in | STAGE 3 · SCREENS 09–13<br>Practice & Journal | STAGE 4 · SCREENS 14–18<br>Reflect & Insights | STAGE 5 · SCREENS 19–24<br>Stress Check & Booking | STAGE 6 · SCREENS 25–30<br>Session & Aftercare |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Goal | Find a private, simple way to feel better. | Name how I feel in under a minute. | Calm down and process my thoughts. | Understand what shapes my mood. | Get professional help when it's too much. | Feel supported and safe over time. |
| Actions | Opens the app<br>Signs up in 3 steps<br>Picks wellness goals<br>Lands on Home | Taps a mood<br>Tags what affected it<br>Adds a short note | Does 4-7-8 breathing<br>Plays a sleep audio<br>Writes a thought record<br>Journals the day | Checks the week chart<br>Reviews top factors<br>Opens Mood Calendar<br>Chats with Aura AI | Answers stress questions<br>Sees a high result<br>Browses psychologists<br>Books & pays | Joins the video session<br>Rates the session<br>Updates profile<br>Saves a safety plan |
| Touchpoints | Welcome<br>Sign Up<br>Goals<br>Home | Mood<br>Factors<br>Note | Practice<br>Breathing<br>CBT<br>Journal<br>New Entry | Insights<br>Mood Calendar<br>AI Summary<br>Aura Chat | Stress Check<br>Result<br>Psychologists<br>Payment | My Sessions<br>Video<br>Rate<br>Profile<br>SOS |
| Thinking | "Is this private? Will it actually help me?" | "Quick — I can do this every day." | "That breathing really helped." | "Sleep really drives my week." | "Is this serious? Can I afford it?" | "I'm not alone in this." |
| Emotion |  Curious but wary | Calm, in control | Relieved, lighter | Aha, self-aware | Anxious, hesitant | Supported, hopeful |
| Pain points | Long sign-up forms<br>Unsure who sees the data | Forgets to check in<br>Tagging feels repetitive | Too many choices<br>Hard to know where to start | Data feels abstract early on<br>Charts need context | Cost anxiety<br>Choice overload<br>Payment friction | Call connection issues<br>Crisis moments at night |
| Opportunities | Privacy promise up front<br>Goal setup in 3 taps | 8 PM gentle reminder<br>Recent factors first, streaks | Picks based on today's mood<br>Short 3–5 min sessions | Plain-language AI summary<br>One weekly tip to try | Clear prices & free intro<br>Match by need<br>Reassuring confirmation | One-tap 1323 hotline<br>Safety plan 1 tap away |

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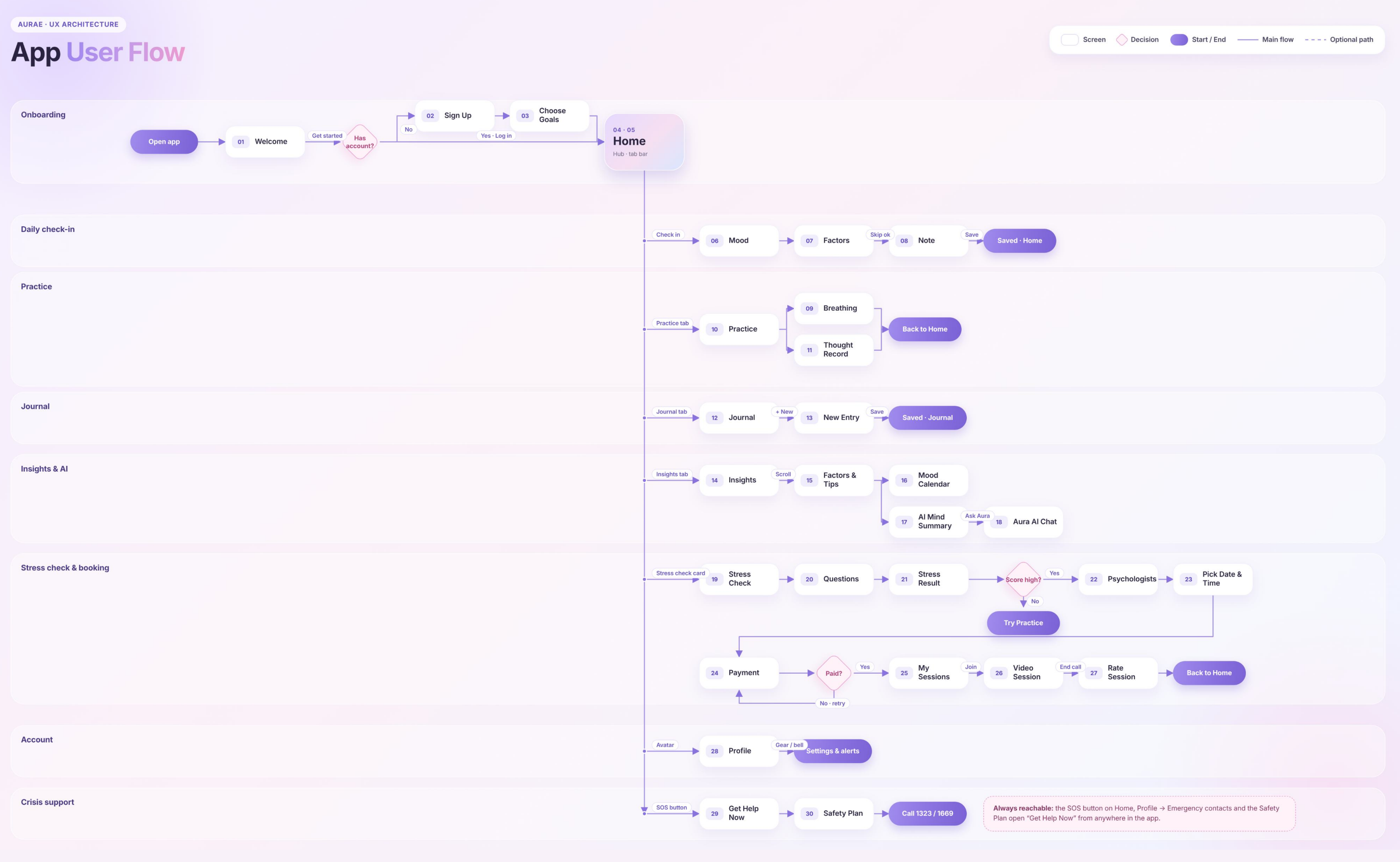
# App User Flow



**Always reachable:** the SOS button on Home, Profile → Emergency contacts and the Safety Plan open "Get Help Now" from anywhere in the app.

## Wireframe User Flow — Aurae

Mental-wellness app · 30 low-fidelity wireframes, one per UI screen, connected by tap paths: sign-in, daily check-in, practice, journal, insights, stress check & booking, sessions and account. Badges show the screen code used in the UI frames on this canvas.